SUNY Old Westbury 2026-2027 Undergraduate Catalog

Course Descriptions

Contract All Courses |

Modern Languages

ML 1000 - Basic French I

Credits: 4 Ea.

Open to students with no previous training in French. Each provides for acquisition of the communication skills in French, with special emphasis on aural comprehension and speaking. Students are also given the opportunity to achieve basic competency in reading and writing.

Prerequisites

No prior French, or not more than one year of high school French

When Offered:

Offered in the Fall and in the Spring.

ML 1010 - Basic French II

Credits: 4 Ea.

Open to students with no previous training in French. Each provides for acquisition of the communication skills in French, with special emphasis on aural comprehension and speaking. Students are also given the opportunity to achieve basic competency in reading and writing.

Prerequisites

ML 1000

or permission of ML faculty

When Offered:

Offered in the Fall and in the Spring.

ML 1100 - Basic Spanish I

ML 1110 - Basic Spanish II

ML 1150 - American Sign Language I

Credits: 4

An introduction to American sign language, the natural language of the deaf community in the United States and Canada. Focuses on conversations in sign, basic rules of grammar and aspects of the deaf community.

When Offered:

In the summer.

ML 1160 - American Sign Language II

Credits: 4

Continuation of basic American sign language and deaf culture study, with opportunities to build receptive and expressive sign vocabulary and phrases; use of signer space; social expressions and body language; introduction to fingerspelling.

Prerequisites

ML 1150

When Offered:

In the summer.

ML 1200 - Basic Chinese I

Credits: 4 Ea.

Open to students with no previous, or limited, knowledge of Chinese. Each provides for acquisition of communication skills in Chinese and introduces writing.

When Offered:

Offered in the fall

ML 1210 - Basic Chinese II

Credits: 4 Ea.

Open to students with no previous, or limited, knowledge of Chinese. Each provides for acquisition of communication skills in Chinese and introduces writing.

Prerequisites

ML 1200

When Offered:

In the spring.

ML 1300 - Basic Arabic Language I

Credits: 4

This course provides an introduction to Modern Standard Arabic, the language of print and broadcast media throughout the Arabic-speaking world. Alongside conversation, a substantial portion of the course will be devoted to mastery of basic reading and writing skills. Students will be introduced to common greetings, numbers, colors and basic vocabulary relevant to everyday environments. By the end of the course, students should be able to formulate questions and present basic information about themselves relating to family and school experience. Music, visual media, maps and other supplementary material (including field trips, as possible) will reinforce language skills and introduce students to the diverse aspects of culture in the Arab world.

When Offered:

Periodically.

ML 1310 - Basic Arabic Language II

Credits: 4

This course continues the introduction to Modern Standard Arabic, the language of print and broadcast media throughout the Arabic-speaking world, begun in Basic Arabic Language I. Students will progress toward simple conversations about themselves and others, classroom and travel experience, leisure activities and basic needs. By the end of the course, students should have mastered several hundred words of vocabulary. Work on reading and writing skills will continue, so that students can create and recognize the vocabulary in written form, as well as understanding authentic printed material such as signs and newspaper headlines. Music, visual media, maps, interviews and other supplementary material (including field trips, as possible) will reinforce both language skills and cross-cultural understanding.

Prerequisites

ML 1300

or permission of Instructor

When Offered:

Periodically.

ML 1400 - Basic Italian I

Credits: 4 Ea.

Open to students with no previous, or very limited, knowledge of Italian. Each provides for acquisition of communication skills in Italian, with emphasis on aural comprehension and speaking. Students will also develop basic competency in reading and writing.

Prerequisites

No prior study of Italian, or not more than one year of high school study

When Offered:

Offered in the fall.

ML 1410 - Basic Italian II

Credits: 4 Ea.

Open to students with no previous, or very limited, knowledge of Italian. Each provides for acquisition of communication skills in Italian, with emphasis on aural comprehension and speaking. Students will also develop basic competency in reading and writing.

Prerequisites

ML 1400

or permission of Instructor

When Offered:

Offered in the spring.

ML 1600 - Basic Punjabi I

Credits: 4 Ea

Basic Punjabi I and II introduce students to basic Punjabi Language skills: reading, writing, speaking and listening. Emphasis is placed on the history and culture of Punjab. Basic I is designed for students with no experience in the language. Basic II is open to students who have completed basic Punjabi I or its equivalent.

ML 1610 - Basic Punjabi II

Credits: 4 Ea

Basic Punjabi I and II introduce students to basic Punjabi Language skills: reading, writing, speaking and listening. Emphasis is placed on the history and culture of Punjab. Basic I is designed for students with no experience in the language. Basic II is open to students who have completed basic Punjabi I or its equivalent.

ML 2005 - French-English Translation

Credits: 4

This is an introductory course in the practice and theory of French to English translation. After a basic introduction to modern translation theory, students will practice the precision skills necessary to understand, analyze and accurately translate short prose texts from French into English. They will learn how to preserve the meaning, style, syntax and tone of source text. Passages selected for translation will come from a variety of sources, including short stories, plays,

newspaper or magazine articles on different topics, and will be of increasing complexity and length.

Prerequisites

ML 1010

or permission of Instructor

When Offered:

This course will be offered periodically, in online format.

ML 2100 - Intermediate Spanish I

ML 2110 - Intermediate Spanish II

ML 2400 - Intermediate Italian I

Credits: 4

The primary aim of this course is to continue learning the Italian language and culture while enabling further communicative proficiency in conversational situations. Emphasis continues on the development of the language skills: speaking, reading, writing and listening to develop advanced cultural understanding and communication.

Prerequisites

ML 1410

ML 2500 - Hispanic Language and Culture

Credits: 4

Taught in Spanish. Increases oral proficiency using authentic reading materials and “real life” situations, which focus on themes such as ethnicity, education, art, religion, economic and political developments in the Spanish-speaking world.

Prerequisites

ML 2100

or Permission of ML faculty

ML 2550 - Intro to Spanish, Latin-American and Latino Cultural Studies

Credits: 4

Students will examine the effects that social and cultural models associated with colonialism, nation building and Western modernity have had on the formation and development of Spanish, Latin American and Latino identities and cultures. Taught in English.

Prerequisites

Permission of ML faculty

ML 2601 - Introduction to Latino and Spanish-Language Media Studies

Credits: 4

Taught in Spanish, this course explores the roles and contributions of Latinx and Spanish- language media in shaping culture, identity, and communication across the United States, Latin America, and Spain. Through a critical lens, students will examine the history, evolution, and impact of Spanish-language media in the United States, the representation of Latinx in mainstream media, and the ways in which media can both reflect and influence the social and political realities of Latinx and Ibero-American communities. Topics will include the study of print, television, radio, film, digital media, and emerging media languages and formats. Students will engage with theoretical frameworks from media studies, communication theory, and cultural studies, as well as apply them to the analysis of specific media texts and productions from Latinx and Spanish-speaking communities. The course will also cover key concepts related to language, representation, immigration, diaspora, coloniality, and decolonial thinking, encouraging students to understand Latinx media within a broader global context.

Prerequisites

Advanced proficency in Spanish is required. Students should have taken any Advance Spanish Classes (ML 3100 or ML 3362), or will need instructor's permission.

Corequisite This course is taught in Spanish.**Prerequisite/Corequisite**

Advanced proficency in Spanish is required. Students should have taken any Advance Spanish Classes (ML 3100 or ML

3362), or will need instructor's permission.

When Offered:

Fall Only

ML 3100 - Advanced Spanish Conversation and Composition

Credits: 4

Designed for both non-native speakers who have had at least two years of Spanish study, and for Hispanic students who need to activate and expand their ability to think and express themselves in their heritage language. This course will provide intensive oral practice on different topics related to Hispanic culture as well as current events of particular interest to students. A variety of reading and writing assignments will help students amplify their vocabulary, lessen the interference of English in Spanish oral communication and strengthen their ability to express ideas both in conversation and in writing.

Prerequisites

ML 2110

or permission of ML faculty

When Offered:

Every fall.

ML 3150 - Modern Italian Civilization

Credits: 4

Taught in English. This course will provide students with an introduction to modern Italian culture and civilization as represented in works of art, literature and film. We will examine the prominent role played by Italy in the development of Euro pean art, culture, history and thought, and the shaping of Western values and taste. From the Renaissance to the present.

Prerequisites

ML 2400

or permission of Instructor

ML 3200 - Translation Workshop

Credits: 4

This is an introductory course in the theory and practice of English/Spanish translation. A variety of prose texts, both literary and non-literary, will be selected for translation, using mostly Spanish as the target language, with some practice of Spanish to English translation. English and Spanish grammar rules are reviewed so students can develop a strong sense of proper usage. Students will work on comparative grammar, style, rhetorical structures and levels of discourse. Emphasis will be placed on expansion of vocabulary in both languages, and on the development of a clearer understanding of the morphological and syntactical differences between the two languages.

Prerequisites

ML 2110

or permission of Instructor

When Offered:

Every other Fall.

ML 3250 - Fundamentals of Spanish Linguistics

Credits: 4

This course provides an essential survey of the major areas of Spanish linguistics geared primarily towards the undergraduate Spanish Education major. Topics to be covered include advanced grammar and syntax, phonology, and lexical morphology. Course readings and fieldwork assignments are intended to provide the student with both a descriptive introduction to the field, which should enable non-natives to improve their own Spanish grammar, listening comprehension and pronunciation; and native speakers to be sensitive to learner difficulties, and to make them more effective educators of Spanish. The course is taught in Spanish with technical terminology given in both Spanish and English.

Prerequisites

ML 2110

or permission of ML faculty

When Offered:

Every other year.

ML 3260 - Spanish Sociolinguistics

Credits: 4

In this course, students will study the key aspects of sociolinguistics and sociolinguistic analysis, including phonological and syntactic variation, regional variants, language and dialect in contact, code-switching among bilinguals, variation by age, gender, educational level and region including an exploration of Spanish in the United States with a view to language planning and language policy. Course is taught in Spanish.

Prerequisites

Ability to read and write in Spanish

ML 3300 - Artistic Expressions of Spain

Credits: 4

Summer course taught in English in Santiago de Compostela, Spain. This course is an overview of the art and culture of Spain through guided readings and visits to museums and galleries. Students will become familiar with masterpieces of Spanish painting, from El Greco to contemporary painters. Artistic styles and movements will be discussed, as well as the influence of various cultures on the arts of Spain.

Prerequisites

EC II

ML 3310 - Chicano/a Cultural Studies

Credits: 4

Through interdisciplinary, cross cultural studies in the humanities this course examines current historical and theoretical writings on the lived experiences of Chicano/a in U.S. history. Themes include culture, politics, re-presentations, contestation, social reproduction, identity and difference, and domination/resistance. Taught in Spanish.

Prerequisites

Permission of ML faculty

ML 3330 - Caribbean Studies

Credits: 4

This course consists of a conceptualization of the Caribbean, including its history, regional diversity and popular imaginary, as well as representation of identities, nationalities, gender, social class, and the circumstances that affect those representations. The course integrates perspectives from various disciplines: Cultural Studies and Ethics, Economics, Politics, History, Ecology, and Sociology.

ML 3362 - Advanced Spanish Grammar and Composition

Credits: 4

Designed for both Heritage speakers and second-language learners. The focus of this course is on the development of reading and writing skills through a thorough review of grammar and weekly exercises and compositions. Students will

improve their ability to write in correct Spanish, expand their overall vocabulary and perfect and systematize their knowledge of grammar and correct usage.

Prerequisites

ML 3100

or permission of ML faculty

When Offered:

Every spring.

ML 3410 - Latino/a Writers in the United States

Credits: 4

Taught in English. This course recognizes the contributions of "Latino" writers who have produced a body of literature in English. The works represent the cultural diversity within the Latino communities in the United States, and the response by various authors to questions of acculturation to new social conditions.

Prerequisites

EMS

When Offered:

Every spring.

ML 3430 - Intro to the Pre-Columbian Culture

Credits: 4

An interdisciplinary survey course in the humanities intended to introduce students to the scientific achievements and cultural innovations of the Pre-Columbian civilizations of the Americas from ancient times to the colonial period. The course will draw upon interdisciplinary scholarship including readings from history, art history and anthropology of the cultures of Mesoamerica (Mexico and Central America) and the Andes (Peru, Ecuador, Bolivia, Chile) to identify and explore the contributions to the ancient and early modern world; and current explorations into evidence for Pre-Columbian activity in the Mississippian civilizations of the present day United States.

Prerequisites

EMS or permission of Instructor

When Offered:

In English.

ML 3450 - Italian Cinema-Neorealism to Present

Credits: 4

Italian films, which emphasize post-war genre and Neorealism to present day Italy are viewed, analyzed and discussed in terms of their historical, political, economic, and social context. The selected films cover a wide range of both historical and social perspective. The course is conducted in English and films have English subtitles. Sign Language Courses

ML 3500 - Critical Writing and Textual Analysis

Credits: 4

Taught in Spanish. For the student who is interested in pursuing the study of literature in Spanish, this course develops critical reading and writing skills and introduces methods of textual analysis. Through intensive practice and class discussions, students will refine their ability to express independent ideas, organize their thoughts, develop a theme and interpret a literary text, in order to write effective essays and term papers in Spanish. Revising and rewriting will be an integral part of the course.

Prerequisites

ML 3100

or ML 3362

or permission of ML faculty

When Offered:

Every fall.

ML 3510 - Creative Writing

Credits: 4

Taught in Spanish. This course will function as a broad-based introduction to various forms of writing, such as short fiction, autobiography and non-fiction narrative. Literary works will serve as models through analysis, application and imitation. Class work will consist of technique and style discussions, reading assignments and mostly collaborative writing exercises. Students will be introduced to the concept of a writing workshop, wherein they share pieces with peers in order to give and receive feedback.

Prerequisites

ML 3100

or ML 3362

or permission of ML faculty

When Offered:

Every other fall.

ML 3600 - Introduction to the Study of Hispanic Literature

Credits: 4

Taught in Spanish. A prerequisite for all upper-level literature and culture courses, this course introduces students to the study of literary genres (poetry, drama, the narrative and the essay). Students will also become familiarized with literary schools and aesthetic movements. Works of noted Hispanic authors (plays, short stories and poems) will be read and analyzed with regard to form and content.

Prerequisites

ML 3100

or ML 3362

or ML 3500

or permission of ML faculty

When Offered:

Every spring.

ML 3650 - Cinema of Latin America and the Iberian Peninsula

Credits: 4

Taught in English. This course will provide students with an introduction to Latin American and Spanish films of the 20th and 21st centuries. Topics pertinent to cinema such as Cinema Novo in Brazil, “La movida” in Spain, etc., will be explored. Films chosen will present social, political and cultural issues. Films will be previewed in their native language with English subtitles.

Prerequisites

EC II or permission from ML faculty

ML 3701 - Digital Media in the Spanish World

Credits: 4

Taught in Spanish, this course examines the evolution and impact of digital media and convergence culture in the Spanish-speaking world, with a particular focus on Latin America, U.S. Latinx communities, and Spain. Digital media, in this context, includes social media, digital journalism, podcasts, streaming platforms, and other digital communication technologies. Students will explore how the convergence of traditional media forms with digital platforms has transformed cultural production, distribution, uses, and consumption in Spanish-speaking societies. The course also delves into the implications of digital media for language, culture, and social change in the Spanish-speaking world. By engaging with key concepts like “convergence culture,” “participatory culture,” “platform capitalism,” and “digital activism,” students will gain a nuanced understanding of how media platforms have both reshaped and problematized communication. We will explore the specific role of Spanish-language digital content in a globalized world, examining how digital technologies have allowed for the hybridization of cultures, new forms of social activism, and the creation of cross-cultural connections across local borders.

Prerequisites

Advanced proficency in Spanish is required. Students should have taken any Advance Spanish Classes (ML 3100 or ML 3362), or will need instructor’s permission.**Corequisite** This course is taught in Spanish.**Prerequisite/Corequisite** Advanced proficency in Spanish is required. Students should have taken any Advance Spanish Classes (ML 3100 or ML 3362), or will need instructor’s permission.

When Offered:

Other

ML 3750 - Afro-Cuban Cultures

Credits: 4

This course is an overview of the history and culture of Afro-Cuban traditions through guided readings, lectures at the University of Matanzas Camilo Cienfuegos, visits to national museums and other sites of interest in Cuba. Students will be exposed to key masterpieces of Afro-Cuban artistic expressions in painting, music and other traditions as they are found and expressed in two important cities: Matanzas and Havana.

Prerequisites

Permission of Instructor

When Offered:

In English with Spanish language instruction.

ML 3800 - Modern French Culture: France and the Francophone World

Credits: 4

Taught in English. This course will provide students with an introduction to French culture and civilization. We will analyze the pivotal role played by France in modern European history and culture and the contributions the French and Francophone nations have made in such domains as architecture, fine arts, philosophy, literature and cinema. Starting from the French classical age, in the 17th century, and continuing through the Enlightenment, the age of revolutions, colonialism and post-colonialism, the course aims to give students an understanding of the aesthetic and intellectual currents that have shaped French thought and creative expressions. Readings will include letters, fiction and essays. Modules of discussion and research may include: the emergence of modern subjects; the culture of sensuality; feminism and gender definitions; stories of love and desire; the image of human experience in the French novel; immigration, racism and the multicultural society; the concept of “creoleness”; modernism and the “avant-gardes”; French-American interactions.

Prerequisites

EMS

When Offered:

Periodically.

ML 3880 - Masterpieces of Hispanic Literature

Credits: 4

Selections of outstanding literary works of Spain and Latin America from the picaresque novel to the present. Study includes major writers: Cervantes, Lorca, Unamuno, García Márquez, and others. Given in English.

Prerequisites

EMS

When Offered:

Periodically.

ML 3915 - Experiential Italian Culture: Intonaci!

Credits: 4

This hybrid course incorporates Italian history, culture, art, sociopolitical trends and culminates in a 12-day experience in Tufo, Abruzzo, Italy. The course includes an introduction to modern Italian culture and civilization with a link to its historical past as represented through works of art, literature, articles and video. The Experiential Immersion end of the course incorporating "service in learning" restoration projects (murals and/or mosaic work) will serve to link the academic information into real-life experience, enhancing the students' level of understanding and best practices for comparison and contrast to the students' own life, to build relationships, to create art collaboratively and to be a part of the revitalization of an historical Italian village. Taught in English.

Prerequisites

EMS

ML 4100 - The Spanish Golden Age

Credits: 4

Taught in Spanish. A study of the literature of the Spanish Golden Age (ca. 1500- 1660) which includes some of the major texts and best-known stories of world literature. Students will be guided through the reading and analysis of selections from Cervantes, Rojas, Tirso de Molina, Lope de Vega, Calderon, Gongora, etc. The works presented will provide a basis for the examination of the Baroque concepts of reality and illusion, dream and disenchantment.

Prerequisites

ML 3600

or ML 3500

or permission of ML faculty

When Offered:

Periodically.

ML 4325 - Contemporary Theatre of the Hispanic World

Credits: 4

Taught in Spanish. Selected plays by a variety of Spanish-speaking dramatists will be read and examined critically and analytically. The plays will represent a broad range of styles and subject matter, and touch upon the philosophical, social and cultural issues that have preoccupied Spanish and Latin American playwrights in modern times. Works by Arrabal, Dragun, Garro, Triana, Paz, Fuentes and Vargas Llosa may be included as well as recent performance pieces by Latino playwrights. A focal point of the course will be the preparation of dramatic readings of selected scenes.

Prerequisites

ML 3600

or ML 3500

or permission of ML faculty

When Offered:

Periodically.

ML 4350 - Recurrent Themes in Latin American Painting and Literature

Credits: 4

Taught in Spanish. This course explores the importance of art and literature in the construction of national, cultural and social discourses in Latin America. Representations of Latin America by European engravers of the 16th and 17th centuries will be analyzed alongside excerpts from colonial literary texts concerned with explaining the newly "discovered" lands to their European sponsors. We will look at nationalistic discourses as presented by the Mexican Muralist movement and writings by Octavio Paz. We will also examine the Hispanic Caribbean painters' and writers' project to develop a new artistic vocabulary, and their (dis) illusions with their countries' social and political conditions.

Prerequisites

ML 3600

or ML 3500

or permission of ML faculty

When Offered:

Periodically.

ML 4450 - Hispanic Women Writers

Credits: 4

Taught in Spanish. A close reading and analysis of major works of fiction and poetry by Hispanic women. Students will be introduced to significant pre-20th century authors; however, the main focus of the course will be on contemporary texts. Selected writers from different areas, such as Emilia Pardo Bazan, Maria Luisa Bombal, Julia de Burgos, Rosario Ferre, Elena Poniatowska, Gabriela Mistral, Isabel Allende, et al., will give students a sense of the diversity and range of Hispanic women's writing. We will examine these writers' response to "machismo" and the limited role of women in traditional societies. Questions concerning the feminine literary tradition, such as how the female experience is represented in texts written by women, and whether there is a specifically "female" writing, will also be discussed.

Prerequisites

ML 3600

or ML 3500

or permission of ML faculty

When Offered:

Periodically.

ML 4500 - Culture and Literature of Spain from the Middle Ages to the 18th Century

Credits: 4

Taught in Spanish. A study of the culture and literature of Spain through representative works, beginning with the epic poem El Cid, Spain's first recorded literary work, and continuing through the 18th century. Students will examine the concepts of honor, religious duty, love, conquest, and the nation as represented in the Spanish tradition.

Prerequisites

ML 3600

or ML 3500

or permission of ML faculty

When Offered:

Periodically.

ML 4510 - Civilization and Culture of Spain

Credits: 4

Taught in Spanish. This course will provide students with an introduction to the culture and civilization of Spain. After a brief overview of key events in Spanish history, emphasis will be placed more specifically on contemporary Spain. Analysis and discussion of literary works, films, music and art will help students understand and appreciate the role played by Spain in modern European history and her contributions in the arts as well as in popular culture. Themes for discussion and research may include: the image of human experience in the Spanish novel; pluralism, unity and the Spanish identity; post-modern cinema; the Civil War and the Franco era; Spain as Romantic myth and tourist heaven, etc.

Prerequisites

ML 3600

or ML 3500

or permission of ML faculty

When Offered:

Periodically.

ML 4515 - Recent Narrative from Spain

Credits: 4

Taught in Spanish. This course provides an analytical and historical approach to narratives written in Spain during the last two decades of the 20th century. Students will be introduced to various aesthetic styles (parodic, historical and urban novels and short stories, science fiction and detective novels) which flourished during this period. Special attention will be given to the sociological background and the so-called “post-modern condition” which made those

narratives possible. Authors such as Eduardo Mendoza, José Angel Mañas, Javier Cercas, Belén Gopegui, Manuel Rivas, etc., will be read throughout the semester.

Prerequisites

ML 3600

or ML 3500

or permission of ML faculty

When Offered:

Periodically.

ML 4520 - Culture and Literature of the Spanish Caribbean

Credits: 4

Taught in Spanish. A study of the major literary trends of this century in the Caribbean area (Dominican Republic, Puerto Rico, and Cuba) seen in a general Latin-American sociocultural and political perspective. Representative works by Henriquez Urena, Llorens Torres, Pales Matos, Guillen, del Cabral, Bosch, Marques, Carpentier, Laguerre, Cabrera Infante, Gonzalez, Cesaire, Mir, Burgos, Rodriguez-Julia, etc.

Prerequisites

ML 3600

or ML 3500

or permission of ML faculty

When Offered:

Periodically.

ML 4540 - Latin American Culture and Literature: From the European Conquest to Independence

Credits: 4

Taught in Spanish. This course will examine the variety of genres produced in Latin America, from the earlier historical writings (diarios, crónicas, relaciones, poemas épicos, etc.) through the European-inspired literatures of the Baroque, Neoclassic, and Romantic periods. The social and political ideas of the Enlightenment and subsequent "progressive" (liberal) ideologies, culminating in the Latin American Wars of Independence and the modern process of "nation

building," will be studied within a literary context.

Prerequisites

ML 3600

or ML 3500

or permission of ML faculty

When Offered:

Periodically.

ML 4545 - Civilization and Culture of Latin America

Credits: 4

Taught in Spanish. This course will serve as an introduction to various aspects of daily life and culture in Latin American countries from early times to the present. We will explore the question of the Latin-American identity: What is Latin America and who are the Latin Americans? We will consider some of the significant intellectual, artistic, historical, and sociopolitical movements that have shaped Latin America since the beginning of its history. Major periods to be examined will be the pre-Columbian civilization, the "Conquista" and the colonial empire, the independence movements and the contemporary period. Students will become familiarized with major issues and institutions of Latin America as represented in contemporary Latin American essays, films, art, music, short stories, plays and novels.

Prerequisites

ML 3600

or ML 3500

or permission of ML faculty

When Offered:

Periodically.

ML 4630 - Latin American Literature

Credits: 4

Taught in English. This course is a survey of Latin American literature since the conquest. The class will first read and discuss descriptions of the Americas as seen by the first European conquerors as well as pre-Colombian texts written by

native Americans. We will then read representative works of various literary periods from baroque poems to "magical-realist" novels. We will analyze such themes as the collision of cultures, "civilization and barbarity", the African influence on Latin American letters and the making of a Latin American identity.

Prerequisites

EMS

When Offered:

Periodically.

ML 4645 - French Literature

Credits: 4

Taught in English. This survey course is intended to serve as an introduction to French literature from the French classical age, in the 17th century, to the present time. Students will be guided through the reading and analysis of narrative fiction, plays and poems by major French writers so as to develop an understanding of the aesthetic and intellectual currents that have shaped French literature. Readings will be organized around thematic modules rather than in chronological order. Topics may include: representations of the self; stories of love and desire; the making of modernity; tradition and experimentation; social reflections; colonialism and post-colonialism, among others.

Prerequisites

EMS

When Offered:

Periodically.

ML 4700 - Studies in Spanish Literature of the Nineteenth and Twentieth Centuries

Credits: 4

Taught in Spanish. A study of the major literary trends prevailing in Spain from the beginning of the 19th century to late 20th century: Romanticism, Realism, Naturalism, the "Generation of '98", the "Generation of '27", the era known as "la postguerra" and postmodernism. Representative works of poetry and prose will serve as an illustration of the historical, social and artistic issues characteristic of each period.

Prerequisites

ML 3600

or ML 3500

or permission of ML faculty

When Offered:

Periodically.

ML 4725 - The Novel and the City

Credits: 4

Taught in Spanish. The course explores the basic connection between the modern period and the novel as a form, noting the parallel rise to prominence of the novel and the large urban centers. By the 19th century, the novel had become the most widely read form of literature, in Europe as well as in the Americas, and thus exercised considerable power not only to express but also to shape urban readers' understanding of themselves, their desires, and their relation to their social world. A selection of city-centered novels by Spanish and Latin American writers of the 19th and 20th centuries will help students understand how writers expand our awareness of urban sites and how they develop complex sets of themes and aesthetics concerns central to the urban experience. We will study crucial interpretive and narratological issues (character development, time and point of view) while also researching the development of public architecture and urban planning in the cities in question.

Prerequisites

ML 3600

, or ML 3500

or permission of ML faculty

When Offered:

Periodically.

ML 4750 - Fiction Into Film: the Spanish and Latin American Cinema

Credits: 4

Taught in Spanish. A study of classic Spanish-speaking films from Latin America and Spain and their contribution to Hispanic culture. The class will view, discuss and analyze films in the context of socio-political events and aesthetic

movements, and place each work in cultural perspective. Particular attention will be paid to the ways in which literary works are translated into cinematic form, and to contrasting narrative practices in the novel and in film.

Prerequisites

ML 3600

or ML 3500

or permission of ML faculty

When Offered:

Periodically.

ML 4800 - Modernism and Modernity: The Latin American Experience

Credits: 4

Taught in Spanish. An historical and analytical approach to the Modernist and Avant-garde movements in Latin American letters. Students will be introduced to the various aesthetic styles which flourished from the late 19th to the middle of the 20th century. The course will examine major poetic trends, as well as representative prose fiction of the two periods (Modernismo and Vanguardismo), paying particular attention to symbolism, decadentism, impressionism, surrealism, cubism, etc.

Prerequisites

ML 3600

or ML 3500

or permission of ML faculty

When Offered:

Periodically.

ML 4900 - The Art of the Latin American Short Story

Credits: 4

This course is a study of the short story genre, including the history and development of the short story as a prose of fiction form. It is designed to give the student the opportunity to read and analyze a wide variety of Latin American short stories. Through reading, discussion and writing we will explore what a literary work can reveal about our

understanding of ourselves and society and how a work of fiction reveals the complex influences that shape one's identity and view of the world. This is a writing intensive course, not a creative writing course. Prerequisite: ML 3500 or ML 3600, or instructor's permission. This course is taught in Spanish.

Prerequisites

Prerequisite: ML 3500 or ML 3600, or instructor's permission.

Corequisite

This course is taught in Spanish

Prerequisite/Corequisite

Prerequisite: ML 3500 or ML 3600, or instructor's permission. This course is taught in Spanish

When Offered:

Other

ML 5400 - Contemporary Literary Theory and Its Applications

Credits: 4

Taught in Spanish. Recent contributions by Jacques Derrida (deconstruction theory), Edward Said (on orientalism), Julia Kristeva and Hèléne Cixous (feminist theories) have questioned the authority of the author as well as the reader, and have brought into consideration other mechanisms that affect our critical evaluation of the world around us. This course attempts to establish principles for interpreting and evaluating literary texts, visual arts and films through readings of contemporary literary theory.

Prerequisites

ML 3600

or permission of ML faculty

When Offered:

Every third year.

ML 5450 - Major Trends in Latin American Thought

Credits: 4

Taught in Spanish. The course examines the major intellectual and artistic trends in Latin American letters, as reflected in the works of representative writers: Sarmiento, Bello, Martí, Rodó, Henriquez-Ureña, Mariategui, Zea, Paz, Vargas Llosa, among others. Readings of the historical, social and literary essay will constitute the primary focus of the course. Special attention will be given to regional and cultural differences. Topics such as race and ethnicity; national identity; the role of women in society, etc., will be closely examined.

Prerequisites

ML 3600

or permission of ML faculty

When Offered:

Every third year.

ML 5650 - Contemporary Latin American Narrative

Credits: 4

Taught in Spanish. Introduction to narrative techniques and socio-political topics prevalent in the contemporary Spanish American narrative. Authors include Borges, Arguedas, Cortazar, Carpentier, Rulfo, Bombal, Garcia Marquez, Fuentes, Roa Bastos, Vargas Llosa, Poniatowska, Allende, etc.

Prerequisites

ML 3600

or permission of ML faculty

When Offered:

Every third year.

ML 5900 - Senior Seminar

Credits: 4

With the guidance and supervision of a faculty member, students must prepare a Senior Thesis. The thesis must focus on a specific area of Spanish language, Hispanic literature and culture involving detailed research.

Prerequisites

Senior Standing in ML program; EMS Students must have the approval of the Modern Languages Chair in order to register for this course Note: Students may choose to take an additional 4000- or 5000-level course instead of completing Senior Seminar

When Offered:

Every semester.

Contract All Courses |